

Advertiser-friendly content guidelines

If you're in the YouTube Partner Program, you can share revenue from ads. This article aims to help you understand which individual videos or Shorts on your channel are suitable for advertisers. Creators can use this article to understand both the platform's self-certification questionnaire and specific rules about what will receive ad earnings, will receive limited ad earnings, and what will receive no ad earnings. Our policies apply to all portions of your content (video, Short, or live stream, thumbnail, title, description, and tags).

Best practices for creating advertiser friendly content

If you're in the YouTube Partner Program and want to make money through ads, make sure your content follows our [advertiser-friendly content guidelines](#).

We take all aspects of your content into account. When we talk about content, we mean your:

- Video, Short, or live stream content
- Title
- Thumbnail
- Description
- Tags

To be suitable for ads, all your content must meet our advertiser-friendly content guidelines.

Add context to your videos

Context is key. If there's educational, documentary, scientific, or artistic value, that may change a video's suitability for advertisers.

Adding context also helps us make the correct monetization decision. Our systems don't always get it right. If our systems mark your video as not suitable for all advertisers, you can [request human review](#). Our human reviewers will assess your content and context to make a final monetization decision.

Learn more about [how reviewers assess content](#) using our advertiser-friendly content guidelines.

Inappropriate language

Content that contains profanity or vulgarity at the start or throughout the majority of the video may not be suitable for advertising. Occasional use of profanity (such as in music videos, backing tracks, intro/outro music, or music played in the background) won't necessarily result in your video being unsuitable for advertising.

Policy Detail

Violence

Content where the focal point is on blood, violence, or injury, when presented without other context, is not suitable for advertising. If you're showing violent content in a news, educational, artistic, or documentary context, that additional context is important. For example, if a video provides news reporting on a violent event like a terrorist attack in a journalistic context, it may be eligible for monetization. Violence in unedited video gameplay is generally acceptable for advertising, but

montages where gratuitous violence is the focal point is not. All games (whether realistic or non-realistic) are in scope of this policy.

Policy Detail

Adult content

Content that features highly sexualized content in the title or thumbnail or highly sexualized themes is not suitable for advertising. There are limited exceptions for non-graphic sexual education videos and music videos. This policy includes both real and computer-generated visuals. Stating comedic intent does not make highly sexualized content suitable for advertising.

Policy Detail

Shocking content

Content that may upset, disgust, or shock viewers may not be suitable for advertising. Unobscured shocking elements won't necessarily result in your video being unsuitable for advertising, but context matters.

Policy Detail

Harmful acts and unreliable content

Content that promotes harmful or dangerous acts resulting in serious physical, emotional, or psychological injury is not suitable for advertising.

Policy Detail

Hateful & derogatory content

Content that incites hatred against, promotes discrimination, disparages, or humiliates an individual or group of people is not suitable for advertising. Content that is satire or comedy may be exempt. Stating your comedic intent is not sufficient and that content may still not be suitable for advertising.

Policy Detail

Recreational drugs and drug-related content

Content that promotes or features the sale, use, or abuse of illegal drugs, regulated legal drugs or substances, drug trafficking organizations or other dangerous products is not suitable for advertising.

Policy Detail

Firearms-related content

Content focused on the sale, assembly, abuse, or misuse of real or fake firearms is not suitable for advertising.

Policy Detail

Controversial issues

Controversial issues are topics associated with trauma, abuse, or that may be unsettling for viewers. This policy may apply even if the content is purely commentary.

Topics covered under Controversial issues policy are child abuse, adult sexual abuse, sexual harassment, self-harm, suicide, eating disorders, domestic abuse, and abortion.

Policy Detail

Sensitive events

March 23, 2022: Due to the war in Ukraine, content that exploits, dismisses, or condones the war is ineligible for monetization until further notice. This update is meant to clarify, and in some cases expand, our guidance as it relates to this war.

A sensitive event is an event or development that creates significant risk to Google's ability to provide high quality, relevant information and ground truth, and reduce insensitive or exploitative content in prominent and monetized features. During a sensitive event, we may take a variety of actions to address these risks.

Examples of sensitive events include civil emergencies, natural disasters, public health emergencies, terrorism and related activities, conflict, or mass acts of violence. This policy applies even if the content contains no graphic imagery.

Policy Detail

Enabling dishonest behavior

Content glorifying or promoting dishonest behavior, such as trespassing, cheating, or computer hacking that is personal or paid for.

Policy Detail

Inappropriate content for kids and families

Content that is [“made for kids”](#) must be appropriate for a family audience in order to monetize on YouTube. This means it must follow YouTube’s [quality principles for kids and family content](#) and [our Program Policies](#).

Policy Detail

Tobacco-related content

Content that promotes tobacco and tobacco-related products is not suitable for advertising. This policy falls under Harmful or dangerous acts in the self-certification questionnaire in YouTube Studio, so be sure to check that one as well for detailed guidance.

Examples (non-exhaustive)

Incendiary and demeaning

Content that is gratuitously incendiary, inflammatory, or demeaning may not be suitable for advertising. This policy falls under Hateful & derogatory content in the self-certification questionnaire in YouTube Studio, so be sure to check that one as well for detailed guidance.